

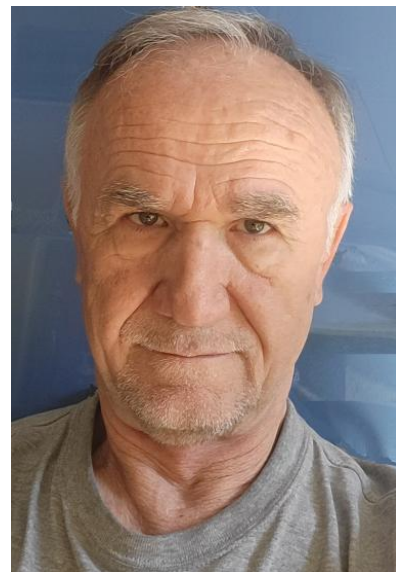
The Tandara Family Genealogy

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Dear Visitor,

Welcome to the website dedicated to the history, origins, and heritage of the Tandara surname. My name is Jure Tandara. I live in Zagreb with my wife, have two wonderful sons and five delightful grandchildren who bring special joy to this stage of my life. After a long and fulfilling professional career, I now devote my time to family, researching our roots, and everything that connects me with nature and creativity.

My professional path included positions of responsibility in road transport, including management of the Container Terminal in Zagreb, the Traffic Safety Service of ARZ, and leadership of the implementation project for the RDS-TMC system in the Republic of Croatia, an important step forward in modern traffic information services.



In addition to my career, I dedicated a significant part of my life to sport and technical craftsmanship. I hold a black belt in karate and was a former national team member of Karate Club Tempo. For many years I was involved in skiing, mountaineering, and cycling. I also found great satisfaction in building models of historic ships, replicas of Roman and ancient war machines, and wooden toys for my five grandchildren.

Today I enjoy spending time in nature and with my grandchildren, creating memories that transcend generations. My family, children, grandchildren, and friends remain my greatest source of inspiration and happiness.

ABOUT THIS PROJECT

This project was created with the aim of collecting, preserving, and systematically presenting information about our ancestors, family branches, places where they lived, and events that shaped the history of the Tandara family.

Over time, many valuable records have been lost, forgotten, or scattered among archives and private collections. The purpose of this website is therefore to preserve our family identity, historical heritage, and memories for present and future generations.

The genealogical trees and information published here are the result of many years of research in church archives, parish registers, historical records, archival materials, and testimonies from family members. A special place in this research belongs to Milan Lažeta, whose publication "Genealogy of the Tandara Clan" laid the foundation for further study of the history and origin of our family.

WHY THIS WEBSITE EXISTS

This website is not merely a collection of data. It is:

- a network of our ancestors
- a story of migrations, struggles, and survival
- a place where past and present meet
- a foundation for future generations

MY PERSONAL MISSION

My mission is simple:

- preserve everything we know about the Tandara family
- connect all branches, near and distant
- make information clear and accessible
- leave a legacy for generations to come

ORIGIN OF THE TANDARA SURNAME

The surname Tandara belongs to the old family lineages of the Imotski region and forms part of Croatian cultural heritage. Its development and standardization are closely connected with the historical and administrative changes that affected the Imotski area during the eighteenth century.

During Ottoman rule, families were not recorded under fixed surnames. Administrators generally recorded only household heads, personal names, and occasional nicknames for taxation purposes.

The earliest known reference connected with the present surname dates from 1725, when Ivan Tandarić was granted a plot of arable land in Ričice. The surname form Tandarić was a typical patronymic and later gradually evolved into the standardized form Tandara.

Following the liberation of the Imotski region from Ottoman rule and the establishment of Venetian administration, cadastral records and parish registers were introduced, together with the requirement for fixed surnames. The first undisputed record of the standardized surname Tandara appears in a baptismal register from 1762.

A reference from 1697 mentioning the surname Tandar in Cista suggests a possible earlier

origin of the family there, although a direct genealogical connection cannot be proven.

DEVELOPMENT AND SPREAD OF THE SURNAME

The core homeland of the family was Ričice. The first major migration occurred between 1806 and 1819, when branches of the family settled in Zavelim. From these families developed all later Zavelim branches of the Tandara lineage.

During the nineteenth and twentieth centuries, members of the family spread throughout Austria, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Slovenia, Serbia, Switzerland, Germany, the United Kingdom, Canada, and the United States.

SLOVAKIA

The surname Tandara appears in the Slovak cities of Žilina and Košice and is pronounced exactly as in Croatian. Since no known Slovak linguistic root explains the surname, it is likely of immigrant origin.

ROMANIA

Romania contains both the village name Țandăra and the surname Țandără, but these are pronounced differently from the Croatian surname. There is no proven historical, linguistic, or genealogical connection between the Romanian and Dalmatian forms.

MEANING OF THE NAME TANDARA IN DIFFERENT REGIONS

Croatia:

One possible theory links the surname with the Turkish word “tandır”, a traditional clay oven used for baking bread and preparing food. However, no historical evidence currently confirms this theory.

Australia:

The names Tandara and Tandarra originate from Aboriginal languages and have no connection with the Croatian surname. Their meanings are commonly interpreted as “camp here” and “resting place.”

Brazil:

In Brazil and parts of South America, Tandara is a female given name rather than a surname and is associated with beauty, strength, and freedom.

CONCLUSION

Within the vast mosaic of the Dinaric karst, on the historical and geographical borderland of

Dalmatia and western Herzegovina, the destiny of the Tandara family was forged over centuries. Two places form the historical heartland of the surname: the village of Ričice and the settlement of Tandare in Zavelim.

From these proud and rugged lands, generations of Tandaras began their migrations, leaving an enduring mark wherever life carried them.

Thanks to the dedicated research of Milan Lažeta, published in the landmark work “Genealogy of the Tandara Clan” in 2012, the migration routes and genealogies of the family can now be traced across centuries.

Today more than 300 people bearing the surname Tandara live in Croatia. What began around the stone hearths of Ričice and Zavelim has spread throughout the world. Whether living in a modern city, on the plains of Slavonia, or remaining on ancestral land, the connection with their roots remains unbroken.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

This project would not have been possible without the dedicated work of Milan Lažeta, author of “Genealogy of the Tandara Clan.” I also thank my cousin Vice Tandara for introducing me to this valuable publication and for providing access to the books that inspired this website.

This website is intended as an open and lasting repository of information about our shared genealogy, preserving our family heritage and connecting present and future generations.